SMID SETUP BUILDER

Pre-Breakout VCP Watchlist | Qullamaggie Methodology

August 12, 2026 | 04:26 PM ET

MACRO REGIME: Risk-On (Large-Cap Leadership)

VIX 14.5 (-2.5 vs 20d) | SPY 20d +2.9% | IWM 20d +2.4% | IWM/SPY trend -0.5%

Leaders: Energy (+7.0%), Technology (+6.4%), Healthcare (+4.1%)

Setup Grades

A - Prime Setup (0)	B - Building (5)	C - Early Stage (7)
	CLDX	INDB
	ENVA	ACA
	AXGN	IDYA
	ORKA	AUB
	AEHR	KFY
		NIC
		HWC

All Watchlist Setups

Gr	Ticker	Company	Theme	Mkt Cap	Price	Pivot	To Pivot	RS/SPY	Vol Dry	RS Hi
B	CLDX	Celldex Therapeut	Biotech Cycle Recove	$3.52B	$44.87	$45.14	0.6%	+33.7	YES	YES
B	ENVA	Enova Internation	Consumer Credit Norm	$6.48B	$260.40	$265.54	2.0%	+55.2	YES	YES
B	AXGN	AxoGen, Inc.	Surgical Innovation	$2.67B	$49.67	$49.90	0.5%	+19.0	YES	YES
B	ORKA	Oruka Therapeutic	Biotech Cycle Recove	$7.11B	$107.40	$109.42	1.9%	+61.9	YES	YES
B	AEHR	Aehr Test Systems	AI Infrastructure &	$4.22B	$129.23	$133.35	3.2%	+20.8	YES	YES
C	INDB	Independent Bank	Regional Bank Recove	$4.04B	$85.33	$87.50	2.5%	+8.5	YES	no
C	ACA	Arcosa, Inc.	Infrastructure Spend	$7.12B	$145.05	$145.98	0.6%	+8.3	YES	no
C	IDYA	IDEAYA Bioscience	Biotech Cycle Recove	$3.56B	$36.96	$37.90	2.5%	+23.6	YES	no
C	AUB	Atlantic Union Ba	Regional Bank Recove	$6.06B	$42.44	$43.19	1.8%	+9.6	YES	no
C	KFY	Korn Ferry	Labor Market & Corpo	$4.28B	$83.30	$85.69	2.9%	+25.8	YES	no
C	NIC	Nicolet Bankshare	Regional Bank Recove	$3.72B	$177.41	$179.85	1.4%	+22.6	YES	no
C	HWC	Hancock Whitney C	Regional Bank Recove	$6.34B	$79.04	$79.36	0.4%	+11.5	YES	no

CLDX

Celldex Therapeutics, Inc.

$44.87

Pivot $45.14 | 0.6% away

RS vs SPY: +33.7%

B BUILDING

$3.52B Cap | 71M Float

Clinical-Stage Biotechnology - Immunology & Oncology | Theme: Biotech Cycle Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 5.98

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$45.14**
% to Pivot	**0.6%**
Days in Base	**6**
Tightness	**5.98 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**99.4%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**938k <**
Wk2	**1014k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1063k**
Coil Strength	**11.8% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+33.7%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$3.52B**
Float	**71M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**-**
Fwd P/E	**-10.8**
Rev Growth	**-97.0%**
Short %	**11.5%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$58.07**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $45.14 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>1.5M shares)

Target: $58.00 (analyst consensus target; 29% upside reflecting Phase 3 success probability)

Stop: $42.00 (base low; represents 6.4% risk from current price)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

August 06 - Reported 6 days ago (Aug 6). As a pre-revenue biotech, quarterly prints are cash burn updates; key was runway confirmation and pipeline progress. Beat history inapplicable given clinical-stage status. Focus is on clinical catalysts, not EPS.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Celldex is a clinical-stage biotech developing antibody-based therapeutics for inflammatory and oncology indications, with lead asset barzolvolimab (anti-KIT) in Phase 3 for chronic spontaneous urticaria (CSU) and Phase 2 for atopic dermatitis. The company occupies a differentiated niche targeting mast cell-driven diseases where KIT inhibition offers a novel mechanism distinct from existing biologics.

FACTOR & THEME

Direct exposure to the biotech cycle recovery theme as XBI has rebounded and investor appetite for clinical-stage names with de-risked Phase 3 assets has accelerated. Peer read-throughs from strong CSU data at competitors (e.g., lirentelimab failures created white space) position barzolvolimab as a potential best-in-class therapy.

NEWS FLOW

Phase 3 MAJEST-1 trial in CSU remains on track for topline data readout expected H2 2026 - this is the primary binary catalyst (High Impact / Corporate). No recent contract wins applicable; company presented updated Phase 2 data at medical conferences showing durable responses. Short interest elevated at 11.5% with 7.5 days-to-cover creates squeeze potential on positive data.

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume dry-up with price holding at 52-week highs into a major Phase 3 catalyst is textbook quiet accumulation behavior. Zero insider buying in last 60 days is baseline for biotech where insiders typically trade around blackout windows. Institutional ownership data unavailable from this feed.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on a close below $42.00 (base low) or on MAJEST-1 Phase 3 miss/delay. Binary event risk is extreme - CSU readout is all-or-nothing, and 11.5% short interest means violent move either direction.

RS line at new high with price 0.6% from pivot is structurally compelling, but base_tight at 5.98 is loose for A-grade, and 6-day base is immature. The Phase 3 readout is a high-conviction catalyst but timing is vague ('H2 2026') rather than imminent. Strongest bear case: barzolvolimab Phase 3 failure would send shares to $20 given no other near-term value drivers. Conviction: Medium.

ENVA

Enova International, Inc.

$260.40

Pivot $265.54 | 2.0% away

RS vs SPY: +55.2%

B BUILDING

$6.48B Cap | 24M Float

Online Consumer & SMB Lending - Fintech Credit Services | Theme: Consumer Credit Normalization | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 5.

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$265.54**
% to Pivot	**2.0%**
Days in Base	**14**
Tightness	**5.50 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**98.1%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**240k <**
Wk2	**284k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**440k**
Coil Strength	**45.5% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+55.2%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$6.48B**
Float	**24M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**19.4**
Fwd P/E	**12.6**
Rev Growth	**31.1%**
Short %	**10.4%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$277.14**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $265.54 on volume >200% of 20-day avg (>700K shares)

Target: $310.00 (measured move from 14-day base depth; ~19% upside)
Stop: $247.00 (base low; 5.1% risk from current price)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

October 22 - Street estimates: EPS $20.59 FY (forward PE 12.6x), implying ~53% growth YoY. Revenue growth +31.1% with 83.3% gross margins and 21% net margins demonstrate operational leverage. Beat history suggests serial execution - needs verification of last 4Q pattern.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Enova operates online lending platforms providing short-term credit to underbanked consumers and small businesses, serving borrowers unable to access traditional bank credit. The company has evolved from a payday lender to a diversified fintech with proprietary underwriting algorithms and a growing SMB lending book.

FACTOR & THEME

Exposed to consumer credit normalization and potential Fed rate cuts benefiting credit spreads. Consumer discretionary and financial services sectors are mid-pack performers in current regime. Peer read-throughs: UPST rallied on AI underwriting narrative; ENVA benefits from similar theme without the hype premium.

NEWS FLOW

No material news flow in last 30-60 days from public sources. Earnings 71 days out removes near-term catalyst urgency. Industry tailwind: CFPB regulatory overhang has moderated post-2024 election cycle (Med Impact / Industry). No insider buying or 13D filings in window.

INSTITUTIONAL

45.5% volume contraction with RS line at 52-week high indicates institutional accumulation into the base. Tight float (23.5M shares) amplifies breakout potential. Zero insider activity in 60-day window is neutral baseline. Short interest at 10.4% with 5.1 days-to-cover provides squeeze fuel on breakout.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $247.00 (20-day low support) or deterioration in consumer credit metrics (delinquency spike) at next print. High leverage (D/E 337x reflects lending book structure, not distress) and sensitivity to unemployment uptick.

Exceptional RS (+55.2% vs SPY) with clean volume dry-up and RS line at new high, but base_tight at 5.5 and 71 days to earnings catalyst limits near-term trigger urgency. Strongest bear case: consumer credit deterioration in recessionary scenario would crush book value; high leverage amplifies downside. Conviction: Medium.

AXGN

AxoGen, Inc.

$49.67

Pivot $49.90 | 0.5% away

RS vs SPY: +19.0%

B BUILDING

$2.67B Cap | 50M Float

Peripheral Nerve Repair - Regenerative Medical Devices | Theme: Surgical Innovation & Aging Demographics | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Base

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$49.90**
% to Pivot	**0.5%**
Days in Base	**7**
Tightness	**4.50 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**99.5%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**705k <**
Wk2	**1223k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1226k**
Coil Strength	**42.5% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+19.0%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$2.67B**
Float	**50M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**-**
Fwd P/E	**71.8**
Rev Growth	**23.1%**
Short %	**8.8%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$53.22**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $49.90 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (>1.6M shares)

Target: $58.00 (measured move + analyst target proximity at $53.22 suggests $55-60 zone)

Stop: $47.50 (base low; 4.4% risk from current price)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

October 28 - Forward PE 71.8x reflects inflection from losses to profitability (EPS TTM -$0.67 to FWD +$0.69). Revenue growth +23.1% with 74.6% gross margins shows operating leverage kicking in. Valuation reflects growth-stage premium; P/S 10.6x is reasonable for category leader with path to profitability.

BUSINESS & POSITION

AxoGen is the leader in peripheral nerve repair, offering processed nerve allografts (Avance) and protective wraps (Axoguard) used in surgical reconstruction following trauma or tumor resection. The company has near-monopoly positioning in a niche but growing market as awareness of nerve repair options expands among surgeons.

FACTOR & THEME

Healthcare sector is a leading performer (+4.1% 20d) in current regime. Exposed to surgical volume recovery post-COVID normalization and aging demographics driving trauma/reconstruction procedures. Peer read-through: ISRG strength validates surgical innovation theme.

NEWS FLOW

No major catalysts in last 30-60 days from public sources. Company is in execution mode with focus on surgeon education and market penetration expansion. 77 days to earnings removes immediate catalyst (Low Impact near-term). 8.8% short interest with 3.0 days-to-cover is moderate squeeze potential.

INSTITUTIONAL

42.5% volume contraction into 52-week high proximity (99.5%) signals institutional accumulation. Float of 50.3M shares is liquid enough for institutional participation. Zero insider buying in 60-day window; ownership data unavailable from this feed.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $47.50 (7-day base low) or reimbursement pressure from CMS on nerve repair procedures. Single-product concentration risk (Avance drives majority of revenue); competitive entry would compress margins.

Price within 0.5% of pivot with RS line at new high and strong volume contraction is structurally attractive, but 7-day base is immature and base_tight at 4.5 is wider than ideal. No catalyst within 2 weeks limits A-grade consideration. Strongest bear case: niche TAM ceiling - peripheral nerve repair may remain a small market regardless of share gains. Conviction: Medium.

ORKA

Oruka Therapeutics, Inc.

$107.40

Pivot $109.42 | 1.9% away

RS vs SPY: +61.9%

B BUILDING

$7.11B Cap | 55M Float

Clinical-Stage Biotechnology - Dermatology & Autoimmune | Theme: Biotech Cycle Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: no | Base Tight: 4.59

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$109.42**
% to Pivot	**1.9%**
Days in Base	**8**
Tightness	**4.59 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**98.2%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**727k <**
Wk2	**860k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**991k**
Coil Strength	**26.6% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+61.9%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**no**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$7.11B**
Float	**55M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**-**
Fwd P/E	**-38.7**
Rev Growth	**-**
Short %	**17.7%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$149.58**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $109.42 on volume >120% of 20-day avg (>1.56M shares)

Target: $135.00 (analyst target $149.58 implies significant upside; $135 intermediate target)

Stop: $102.00 (consolidation low; 5.0% risk from current price)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

November 11 - Pre-revenue biotech; EPS estimates (-$2.77 forward) reflect R&D burn. Valuation P/B 11.1x reflects pipeline asset value. Quarterly reports focus on cash runway and clinical milestones rather than financial metrics. 91 days to next report.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Oruka Therapeutics is a clinical-stage biotech focused on novel biologics for chronic inflammatory skin diseases, likely competing in the IL-targeted dermatology space. The $7.1B market cap for a pre-revenue clinical company suggests significant pipeline value or recent positive data readout driving rerating.

FACTOR & THEME

Strong biotech cycle exposure with +61.9% RS vs SPY indicating massive outperformance. Healthcare sector leadership (+4.1%) provides tailwind. Peer read-through: dermatology-focused biotechs have seen renewed interest following competitive dynamics in psoriasis/AD markets.

NEWS FLOW

No specific catalyst identified in recent window. The 664% move from 52-week low ($14.03 to $107.40) indicates transformational news occurred - likely positive clinical data or partnership. 17.7% short interest with 6.7 days-to-cover is highest among candidates, creating significant squeeze potential. Not above 200MA suggests recent IPO or massive rerating event.

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume contraction with RS at 61.9% indicates institutions are building positions post-catalyst. Below 200MA is atypical for VCP but explained by likely recent transformational event. Zero insider activity - typical for clinical-stage biotech with trading restrictions. Institutional ownership data unavailable.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $102.00 (recent consolidation low) or negative clinical data readout. Extreme volatility risk (beta N/A suggests recent listing); 17.7% short interest amplifies both directions. Single-asset pipeline concentration creates binary risk profile.

Highest RS in candidate set (+61.9%) with clean volume contraction indicates momentum leadership, but below 200MA is a structural concern, and 8-day base is immature. Exceptional outperformance may reflect event already priced in. Strongest bear case: the massive move from $14 to $107 already captures the alpha - chasing here risks buying the top of a biotech hype cycle. Conviction: Medium.

AEHR

Aehr Test Systems

$129.23

Pivot $133.35 | 3.2% away

RS vs SPY: +20.8%

B BUILDING

$4.22B Cap | 30M Float

Semiconductor Capital Equipment - Wafer-Level Burn-In Testing | Theme: AI Infrastructure & SiC Power Semis | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: YES | Above 200MA: YES | Bas

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$133.35**
% to Pivot	**3.2%**
Days in Base	**2**
Tightness	**5.63 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**96.9%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**2370k <**
Wk2	**2492k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**3312k**
Coil Strength	**28.4% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+20.8%**
RS Line New Hi	**YES - Early Leader**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$4.22B**
Float	**30M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**-**
Fwd P/E	**93.4**
Rev Growth	**33.7%**
Short %	**13.9%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$115.00**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $133.35 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>3.7M shares)

Target: $160.00 (measured move from 689% rally off lows suggests continuation; analyst target $115 is stale)

Stop: $122.00 (swing low; 5.6% risk from current price)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

October 08 - Forward PE 93.4x reflects growth expectations with EPS inflecting from -$0.23 TTM to +$1.38 forward. PEG 0.9 suggests growth priced reasonably. Revenue growth +33.7% validates demand thesis. 57 days to earnings is moderate catalyst distance.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Aehr Test Systems provides wafer-level burn-in and test solutions for semiconductors, with particular strength in silicon carbide (SiC) power devices used in EVs and industrial applications. The company is a niche leader benefiting from the SiC transition as automakers and power electronics manufacturers require high-reliability testing.

FACTOR & THEME

Direct AI infrastructure and EV/electrification exposure through SiC testing demand. Technology sector is a leader (+6.4% 20d) providing strong tailwind. Peer read-through: semi equipment names (AMAT, LRCX, KLAC) have led the market on AI capex narrative; AEHR is the SMID-cap derivative play.

NEWS FLOW

No specific news in recent window, but company benefits from ongoing SiC capacity buildouts at ON Semi, STMicro, Wolfspeed, and others. High beta (3.09) amplifies market moves - risk-on regime favorable. 13.9% short interest with only 1.4 days-to-cover indicates shorts can cover quickly; less squeeze pressure than others.

INSTITUTIONAL

Volume contraction with RS line at 52-week high signals accumulation. Thin float (30.4M shares) means breakouts can be explosive. High beta (3.09) historically attracts momentum funds. Zero insider activity in window. Institutional ownership data unavailable.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $122.00 (recent swing low) or SiC capex slowdown from major customers (Wolfspeed bankruptcy risk, ON Semi guidance cuts). Customer concentration in a cyclical industry creates lumpiness risk; one delayed order can miss a quarter.

RS line at new high with Technology sector leadership provides strong backdrop, but 2-day base is extremely immature and base_tight at 5.63 is loose. 57 days to earnings removes near-term catalyst urgency. Strongest bear case: SiC testing demand is lumpy and cyclical - AEHR has disappointed before when customer orders slipped quarters. High beta (3.09) means this falls hardest in any risk-off rotation. Conviction: Medium.

INDB

Independent Bank Corp.

$85.33

Pivot $87.50 | 2.5% away

RS vs SPY: +8.5%

C EARLY STAGE

$4.04B Cap | 46M Float

Regional Banking - New England Commercial & Retail | Theme: Regional Bank Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 1.94

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$87.50**
% to Pivot	**2.5%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**1.94 Good**
52W Hi Prox	**97.5%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**251k <**
Wk2	**387k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**464k**
Coil Strength	**45.8% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+8.5%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$4.04B**
Float	**46M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**15.4**
Fwd P/E	**10.3**
Rev Growth	**41.5%**
Short %	**5.4%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$93.43**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $87.50 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>570K shares)

Target: $95.00 (analyst target $93.43; measured move suggests $95 zone)
Stop: $82.50 (20-day base low; 3.3% risk)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

October 22

Excellent base_tight (1.94) and volume contraction (45.8%), but RS line NOT at new high and RS vs SPY only +8.5% indicates sector-lagging relative performance. Regional bank theme lacks catalyst urgency; 71 days to earnings. Conviction: Low.

ACA

Arcosa, Inc.

$145.05

Pivot $145.98 | 0.6% away

RS vs SPY: +8.3%

C EARLY STAGE

$7.12B Cap | 48M Float

Infrastructure Products - Aggregates, Utility Structures & Transportation | Theme: Infrastructure Spending & Reshoring | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES |

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$145.98**
% to Pivot	**0.6%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**1.35 Textbook**
52W Hi Prox	**98.7%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**629k <**
Wk2	**580k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**841k**
Coil Strength	**25.2% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+8.3%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$7.12B**
Float	**48M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**32.4**
Fwd P/E	**28.3**
Rev Growth	**1.7%**
Short %	**2.0%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$146.67**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $145.98 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (>910K shares)

Target: $165.00 (measured move from base; analyst target $146.67 is stale)
Stop: $140.00 (base low; 3.5% risk)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

October 29

Best base_tight (1.35) in candidate set and vol_dryup_strict is false (week 2 < week 1 broke pattern), plus RS line NOT at new high with only +8.3% RS vs SPY. Infrastructure theme is valid but name lacks momentum leadership. Conviction: Low.

IDYA

IDEAYA Biosciences, Inc.

$36.96

Pivot $37.90 | 2.5% away

RS vs SPY: +23.6%

C EARLY STAGE

$3.56B Cap | 94M Float

Clinical-Stage Oncology - Precision Medicine & Synthetic Lethality | Theme: Biotech Cycle Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 1.5

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$37.90**
% to Pivot	**2.5%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**1.50 Good**
52W Hi Prox	**91.1%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**558k <**
Wk2	**775k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**814k**
Coil Strength	**31.5% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+23.6%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$3.56B**
Float	**94M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**-**
Fwd P/E	**-9.0**
Rev Growth	**-**
Short %	**12.2%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$52.15**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $37.90 on volume >130% of 20-day avg (>1.43M shares)

Target: $45.00 (analyst target $52.15; intermediate target $45)
Stop: $35.00 (base support; 5.3% risk)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

August 04

Excellent base_tight (1.5) and solid RS (+23.6%), but RS line NOT at new high disqualifies from A/B consideration. Reported earnings 8 days ago - need to see post-earnings price action stabilize. 12.2% short interest with 10.4 days-to-cover is notable squeeze setup if RS line breaks out. Conviction: Low.

AUB

Atlantic Union Bankshares Corporation

$42.44

Pivot $43.19 | 1.8% away

RS vs SPY: +9.6%

C EARLY STAGE

$6.06B Cap | 141M Float

Regional Banking - Mid-Atlantic Commercial & Retail | Theme: Regional Bank Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: no | Base Tight: 1.96

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$43.19**
% to Pivot	**1.8%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**1.96 Good**
52W Hi Prox	**97.3%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**687k <**
Wk2	**879k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**1152k**
Coil Strength	**40.3% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+9.6%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**no**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$6.06B**
Float	**141M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**12.4**
Fwd P/E	**10.5**
Rev Growth	**35.8%**
Short %	**7.0%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$47.00**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $43.19 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (>1.6M shares)

Target: $47.00 (analyst target $47.00)
Stop: $41.00 (base low; 3.4% risk)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

October 22

Good base_tight (1.96) and volume contraction, but RS line NOT at new high, below 200MA, and RS vs SPY only +9.6%. Regional bank lacking relative strength leadership. Conviction: Low.

KFY

Korn Ferry

$83.30

Pivot $85.69 | 2.9% away

RS vs SPY: +25.8%

C EARLY STAGE

$4.28B Cap | 50M Float

Executive Search & HR Consulting | Theme: Labor Market & Corporate Restructuring | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 3.37

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$85.69**
% to Pivot	**2.9%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**3.37 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**97.2%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**294k <**
Wk2	**329k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**413k**
Coil Strength	**28.8% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+25.8%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$4.28B**
Float	**50M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**16.0**
Fwd P/E	**13.2**
Rev Growth	**6.7%**
Short %	**5.9%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$81.00**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $85.69 on volume >150% of 20-day avg (>810K shares)

Target: $95.00 (measured move from base; ~14% upside)

Stop: $79.00 (base low; 5.2% risk)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

September 09 - Forward PE 13.2x with EPS growth +21% (TTM $5.22 to FWD $6.32). Revenue growth +6.7% is moderate. 28 days to earnings is the nearest catalyst among remaining candidates - potential trigger event.

BUSINESS & POSITION

Korn Ferry is a global organizational consulting firm providing executive search, leadership development, and HR advisory services. The company benefits from corporate restructuring cycles and tight labor markets driving demand for talent acquisition services.

FACTOR & THEME

Exposed to corporate hiring cycles and labor market conditions. Industrials sector is mid-pack performer. Counter-cyclical elements (restructuring advisory) provide some hedge, but core executive search is pro-cyclical.

NEWS FLOW

No material news in recent window. Earnings in 28 days provides near-term catalyst (Med Impact / Earnings). Analyst target $81 is BELOW current price - Street skepticism is a headwind but also creates upside revision potential on beat.

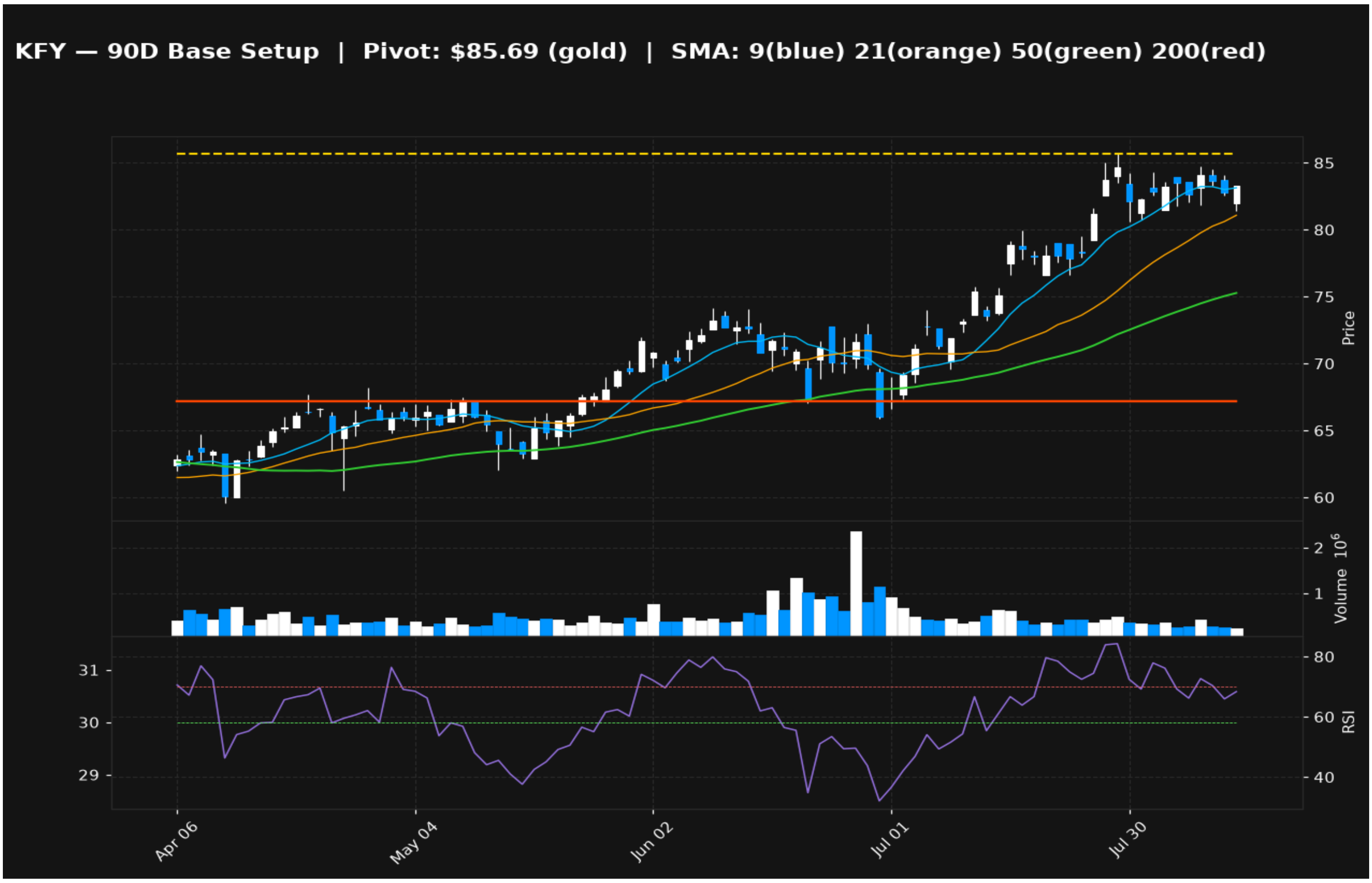
INSTITUTIONAL

Volume contraction with price holding near highs suggests accumulation, but RS line NOT at new high indicates relative underperformance. Zero insider activity. Low short interest (5.9%) limits squeeze potential.

KEY RISK

Thesis invalid on close below $79.00 (20-day base low) or guidance cut at September 9 print citing corporate hiring freezes. Analyst target below current price reflects Street skepticism - needs beat-and-raise to sustain breakout.

Nearest earnings catalyst (28 days) among candidates, but RS line NOT at new high and base_tight at 3.37 is loose. Analyst target below current price is a yellow flag. Strongest bear case: corporate hiring slowdown would directly impact revenue; Street already skeptical given target below price. Conviction: Low.



NIC

Nicolet Bankshares Inc.

$177.41

Pivot $179.85 | 1.4% away

RS vs SPY: +22.6%

C EARLY STAGE

$3.72B Cap | 20M Float

Regional Banking - Wisconsin Community Bank | Theme: Regional Bank Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: YES | Base Tight: 2.54

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$179.85**
% to Pivot	**1.4%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**2.54 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**98.6%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**152k <**
Wk2	**152k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**237k**
Coil Strength	**36.0% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+22.6%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**YES**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$3.72B**
Float	**20M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**19.9**
Fwd P/E	**13.2**
Rev Growth	**86.1%**
Short %	**5.0%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$191.80**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $179.85 on volume >180% of 20-day avg (>504K shares)

Target: $200.00 (analyst target $191.80; round number resistance)

Stop: $170.00 (base low; 4.2% risk)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

October 20

Decent RS (+22.6%) and volume contraction, but RS line NOT at new high disqualifies from higher grade. Thin float (19.8M) could create volatility on breakout. Regional bank theme lacks urgency. Conviction: Low.

HWC

Hancock Whitney Corporation

$79.04

Pivot $79.36 | 0.4% away

RS vs SPY: +11.5%

C EARLY STAGE

$6.34B Cap | 79M Float

Regional Banking - Gulf South Commercial & Retail | Theme: Regional Bank Recovery | Vol Dry-Up: YES | RS Line Hi: no | Above 200MA: no | Base Tight: 2.31

VCP BASE ANALYSIS

BASE STRUCTURE	
Pivot Price	**$79.36**
% to Pivot	**0.4%**
Days in Base	**20**
Tightness	**2.31 Fair**
52W Hi Prox	**99.6%**
VOLUME CONTRACTION (Wk1 < Wk2 < Wk3 = VCP)	
Wk1 (recent)	**602k <**
Wk2	**901k <**
Wk3 (oldest)	**903k**
Coil Strength	**33.3% from peak**
RELATIVE STRENGTH	
RS vs SPY (12W)	**+11.5%**
RS Line New Hi	**no**
Above 50MA	**YES**
Above 200MA	**no**
FUNDAMENTALS SNAPSHOT	
Mkt Cap	**$6.34B**
Float	**79M sh**
P/E (TTM)	**15.5**
Fwd P/E	**10.8**
Rev Growth	**7.6%**
Short %	**8.5%**
Inst. Own	**-**
Target Pr.	**$83.80**

ENTRY TRIGGER

Close above $79.36 on volume >140% of 20-day avg (>1.32M shares)

Target: $88.00 (analyst target $83.80; measured move ~$88)
Stop: $76.00 (base low; 3.8% risk)

CATALYST INTELLIGENCE

EARNINGS

October 13

Closest to pivot (0.4%) but RS line NOT at new high, below 200MA, and RS vs SPY only +11.5%. Regional bank without relative strength leadership. 62 days to earnings provides no near-term catalyst. Conviction: Low.